

FREE GUIDE

Moving to Bali: Visas, Living and Buying

What life here really costs, which visa fits, where to live and when to buy.

By Kai, Bali property adviser · balioffscript.com



THE MONTHLY BUDGET

What life in Bali really costs

LIFESTYLE	PER MONTH
Budget: room, scooter, local food	**$600–900**
Mid-range: apartment or small villa	**$1,100–1,800**
Comfortable single	**$1,800–2,500**
Couple	**$2,500–3,500**
Family with international school	**$4,000–6,500**

Roughly 50 to 65% cheaper than Western Europe for the same lifestyle. But prices have climbed fast since 2022, most of all in Canggu and Seminyak.

WHICH VISA FITS

Your plan decides the visa

IF YOU WANT TO	LOOK AT
Visit, view property	**Visitor visa**
Work remotely, foreign employer	**E33G remote worker**
Run your own company here	**Investor KITAS**
Retire here	**Retirement or Second Home**
Long stay on savings	**Second Home visa**
Settle for good	**KITAP, later**

Buying property and getting residency are separate questions. Hak Pakai, the right to hold a home in your own name, needs a KITAS or KITAP.



WHERE TO LIVE

Pick the area for your life

AREA	SUITS
Canggu, Berawa	**Working, social**
Pererenan	**A quieter Canggu**
Seminyak	**Restaurants, walkable**
Sanur	**Families, retirees**
Ubud	**Calm, creative, wellness**
Uluwatu	**Surf, views, space**
Sidemen, Amed, north	**Real quiet, low cost**

THE FILTERS PEOPLE FORGET

Four things to check first

1. **The school**
   If you have children, pick the school, then live near it.
2. **The hospital**
   Serious care is in Denpasar. Ninety minutes matters more at 3am.
3. **Traffic at your hours**
   Drive it at 8am and 6pm, not at midday.
4. **The rainy season**
   See the road you'd use every day in February.

Rent for a year before you buy, ideally through a wet season. The area that suits a holiday and the area that suits a life are rarely the same.



HONEST EXPECTATIONS

What nobody tells you

Traffic
Worse every year in the busy corridors.

Paperwork
Slow, changeable, never quite finished.

Healthcare
Good everyday care. Get insurance with evacuation cover.

Friends
People come and go. Build your circle on purpose.

183 days
Spend more than this in Indonesia in a year and you're a tax resident here, even on foreign income.



THEN BUYING

When buying makes sense

1. **You've lived here a year**
   You know the area, the traffic and the season.
2. **You know your visa route**
   It decides whether Hak Pakai is open to you.
3. **You've decided: home or income**
   The area that suits you and the one that fills a booking calendar are often different.
4. **Your paperwork checks are done**
   Certificate, zoning, permits and the lease clauses, before any deposit.

WHAT I DO FOR YOU

You don't have to do this alone.

Moving is the big decision. I'll help with where to live and, when you're ready, find the home or land that fits and check it properly.

1. **I find the land**
   In the area and budget that fit your plan, with the zoning checked first.
2. **I find the right property or project**
   Built, off-plan or land to build on. I look at all of them, so you see the honest options.
3. **I check everything before you pay**
   Certificate, zoning, permits, the lease clauses and the seller.
4. **I stay with you to the notary**
   Questions answered straight, in plain words, until the keys are yours.

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Tell me the area, your budget and your timing, and I'll tell you what I would check first. This guide is general information, not legal or tax advice. Rules change: verify with your own notary before you sign.